

Non-Kinetic Military Strategies and the Fight Against Insurgency in South-Eastern Nigeria

¹Atti Joshua Moses & ²Ene Warikiente Robert

^{1&2}*Department of Sociology and Anthropology, Faculty of Social Sciences,
Federal University Otuoke, Bayelsa State, Nigeria*

Article DOI: 10.48028/iiprds/ijargpgm.v5.i1.24

Abstract

This study explores the non-kinetic strategies employed by the Nigerian Army to counter insurgency in Southeast Nigeria, particularly against Militants, herdsmen, bandits, IPOB, unknown gunmen, etc. The aim is to understand the effectiveness of these strategies, the role of community engagement, and the challenges faced. Grounded in the Counter Insurgency Theory, the research utilizes qualitative methods to gather primary and secondary data, particularly in-depth interviews with 45 tactical operational officers. The thematic analysis approach through the use of verbatim quotations was used as analysis tool. Key findings show that the Nigerian Army employs various non-kinetic strategies, including community engagement, collaboration with local vigilante groups, media campaigns, and civic action initiatives aimed at improving community conditions. These strategies have fostered trust, improved intelligence sharing, and shifted public attitudes against extremism, thereby enhancing security in the region. However, deep-rooted distrust stemming from historical grievances, insubordination, and fears about insurgent retaliation persist as significant challenges. The study concludes that a combined approach, integrating military and community-focused strategies, is crucial for achieving lasting peace. Recommendations include enhancing trust through regular communication, addressing root causes of unrest via humanitarian efforts, and engaging local communities in security initiatives to overcome challenges and improve cooperation.

Keywords: *Insurgency, Non-Kinetic Strategy, Nigerian Army, Southeast, Nigeria*

Corresponding Author: **Atti Joshua Moses**

Background to the Study

Insurgency is a complicated form of armed conflict occasioned by a conflict between a non-state group and a state or occupying power. It often involves the use of asymmetric warfare, where smaller, irregular groups challenge conventional military forces (Kilcullen, 2013). The global view of insurgency has evolved, with various movements emerging in response to political, economic, and social grievances. Studies such as Mackinlay (2007), Ekpenyong, Raimi, and Ekenyong (2012), and Raimi (2017) reveal that recent insurgencies are mostly fueled by factors such as ethnic tensions, poverty, and state repression. Mackinlay pointed out that the impact of insurgency extends beyond the borders of the immediate conflict zones, but also affects regional security dynamics and international relations. A critical example is the rise of groups like Al-Qaeda and ISIS, which have prompted global responses and collaborations aimed at counter-insurgency, showcasing a need for effective military and civilian engagement strategies to address the root causes of violence (Mawdsley & Bøås, 2021; Raimi & Boroh, 2017). The interconnected nature of these conflicts reveals the necessity for countries, including Nigeria, to engage tactically and strategically with international partners to combat insurgency effectively.

In the case of Nigeria, there have been significant challenges orchestrated by the rise of insurgent groups, particularly Boko Haram, which emerged in the northeastern region around 2009. The group's violent campaigns have led to thousands of deaths and the displacement of millions. According to the United Nations, the insurgency has created one of the world's worst humanitarian crises, with millions in need of urgent assistance (UN OCHA, 2021; Raimi, 2021).

The Nigerian government's approach to the insurgency has included military operations led by the Nigerian Army. These efforts have been met with varying degrees of success and criticism, particularly regarding human rights abuses and the need for comprehensive strategies that incorporate economic development and community engagement (HRW, 2019). The Nigerian Army's efforts have evolved over the years, with increases in troop deployments and counter-insurgency operations aimed at retaking control of territories occupied by Boko Haram and restoring peace in affected communities.

In the northeastern states of Nigeria, such as Borno, Yobe, and Adamawa, the Nigerian Army has been at the forefront of the military campaign against Boko Haram. Operations like "Operation Lafiya Dole" have been launched to confront the insurgents directly (Sadiq & Elisha, 2019). The Nigerian Army, in collaboration with air and ground forces, has conducted various offensives that have successfully reclaimed territories previously held by insurgents. The Nigerian Army's involvement also extends to collaboration with regional and international partners, including forces from neighboring countries such as Chad and Niger, in a coordinated effort against the cross-border nature of Boko Haram activities. This multidimensional approach has led to some notable successes, such as the liberation of towns and the killing of insurgent leaders (Olojo, 2016). However, challenges persist, including logistical constraints and the need for intelligence sharing across borders (Raimi & Ene, 2019; Dawodu, 2020).

One notable aspect of the Nigerian Army's efforts has been its engagement with local communities particularly in recognizing that military force alone cannot provide lasting solutions or initiatives aimed at de-radicalization and ensuring community reintegration. As a result, the Nigerian Army has participated in the distribution of humanitarian aid and the provision of security for relief efforts in conflict-affected areas (Nwajiaku, 2020; Iwarimie-Jaja & Raimi, 2019). Despite these notable efforts, the issues of insurgency continue to grow, spreading its wings across the nation, with the most recent challenge being in the southeastern part of the country, with cases of unknown gunmen wreaking havoc on the residents of the region. It is against this background that this study is looking at the Non-violent strategies that the Nigerian Army has employed in the fight against insurgency in the country.

Objective of the Study

- i. To identify the primary non-kinetic strategies employed by the Nigerian Army in countering insurgency.
- ii. To evaluate the effectiveness of these strategies in achieving peace and security in the Southeast region.

Literature Review

The Nigerian Army has undergone significant transformations throughout its history, evolving from colonial beginnings into a complex security institution deeply intertwined with the nation's political and social fabric. The roots of the Nigerian Army can be traced back to the colonial period, specifically the formation of the West African Frontier Force in the late 19th century. This military structure was established primarily to protect British colonial interests in the region and to suppress local uprisings (Olayiwola, 2014). Soldiers were predominantly drawn from various ethnic groups within Nigeria, a practice that laid the groundwork for the diverse composition of the army. However, this early military institution was more of a tool for colonial control than a genuinely national force, with its loyalty primarily directed towards colonial rule rather than the aspirations of Nigerian society.

Following Nigeria's independence in 1960, the Nigerian Army began to take on a dual role: that of a national defense force and a potential player in political governance. The country experienced its first military coup in January 1966, which abruptly altered the trajectory of the army from a purely military organization to one that became heavily involved in politics. The coup was partly motivated by ethnic tensions and dissatisfaction with the political elite, showcasing the underlying national divisions (Falola, 2009). This moment marked the beginning of a series of military regimes that would dominate Nigerian politics for decades, with the army often acting as both enforcer and arbiter of power.

In addition, the Nigerian Civil War (1967-1970), also known as the Biafran War, was equally an important moment in the history of the Nigerian Army. The conflict erupted due to ethnic tensions and the desire for the southeastern region, predominantly inhabited by the Igbo ethnic group, to secede. The army's role during this period was multifaceted, involving both conventional military engagements and counter-insurgency operations aimed at quelling the secessionist movement (Hochschild, 2011). The war had profound implications for the army's

structure and ethos, fostering a sense of unity within its ranks but also entrenching a militaristic approach to governance and conflict resolution in Nigeria (Iwarimie-Jaja & Raimi, 2019).

Furthermore, the return to civilian rule in the late 1990s brought about another transformation for the Nigerian Army. The institution faced the challenge of redefining its role in a democratic society, striving to distance itself from its past involvement in politics (Oluwole, 2018). This transition, however, has been fraught with difficulties. The army has continued to encounter multiple internal and external security threats, particularly the rise of insurgency in the northeastern part of the country, mainly due to groups like Boko Haram and more recently in southeastern part of the country with the case of unknown gunmen. Interestingly, by way of response to the seemingly growing security threats, particularly from insurgent groups (Iheriohanma, Opara, & Raimi, 2020). The Nigeria Police Force and its constitutional responsibility in the present democratic dispensation. *Issues Business Management and Economics*, 8(4), 84-96

The Nigerian Army has been compelled to adapt its strategies and operations. The fight against Boko Haram has necessitated a focus on counter-insurgency tactics, including intelligence gathering, community engagement, and humanitarian assistance (Adebajo, 2015). This evolution reflects a shift from traditional military engagements towards more complex, civilian-centric operations aimed at both neutralizing threats and addressing the socio-economic grievances that fuel insurgency. Sadly, despite these adaptations, the Nigerian Army continues to struggle with issues of discipline, human rights abuses, and corruption, which have tarnished its reputation and the trust of the civilian population (Okoro & Ugochukwu, 2020). These challenges reflect the ongoing need for reform and the establishment of more robust mechanisms of accountability and oversight within the institution.

Methods

The study used a qualitative research design to thoroughly examine how non-violent strategies has been used in the Nigerian Army's fight against insurgency. The sample size of this study is 148 officers working in different local government areas and communities throughout the region. A multistage sampling technique was used in the investigation. In the first stage, the study used convenience sampling to determine the research area for the study based in proximity with the research team. In the second stage, the study employed the purposive or judgmental sampling to handpick the first participant for the interviews. In the third and final stage, the study employed the snowball sampling techniques to identify the next participants based on reference from the initial respondent. Following this combination of methods, the research was able to collect detailed information from tactical operational officers designated to this region about their operations and strategies. This way, the data gathered was directly relevant to the goals of the study. The study's primary data was gathered through a Key Informant Interviews (KIIs), while secondary data was obtained from published sources. The respondents were fully informed about the study's objectives and their other rights as participants, including anonymity. The qualitative information collected with electronic tape

and notes were later transcribed, synthesized and organized under thematic headings. Significant statements were quoted verbatim to corroborate or refute important findings.

Results

Substantive data

Theme 1: Primary non-kinetic strategies employed by the Nigerian Army in countering insurgency.

In examining the Nigerian Army's responses to insurgency, the study revealed a plethora outcome especially on the issue of existing strategies employed to counter insurgency against groups like unknown gun men. Following this probe, one of our respondents pointed out a civil approach.

According to this respondent;

The military operations often involve excessive force, resulting in civilian casualties and additional unrest, which contradicts the objective of achieving community stability. This ongoing cycle of violence not only damages the military's credibility but also diminishes public trust in its operations. So, one common non-violent strategy we have adopted is engaging with the local communities. We talk to people, hold meetings, and listen to their concerns. This helps us to build trust and encourage open communication between the security units and the local population. This strategy has helped us to get better information about potential threats, and insurgents' hideouts. It has also helped us establish a fearless atmosphere for the villagers there by making residents feel safer. This collaboration and connection have led to more cooperation from the locals, which is key in the fight against insurgents. IDI Participant, Male, Tactical operational officer, Orlu community, aged undisclosed).

This is to say that the military has demonstrated a willingness in the fight against insurgency in the region by adopting approaches that focus on non-violence and community engagement. This strategy shows a recognition that true progress often comes not just from military action, but from building relationships with the people who are most affected by violence and instability. Engaging with local communities reflects an understanding that the military's effectiveness is enhanced when they have the support and trust of the residents. So, as they hold meetings and listen to the concerns of the locals, the military is not just imposing authority; they are fostering a dialogue that makes people feel heard and valued. This effort to communicate openly paves the way for more insightful and accurate information regarding potential threats, including the locations of insurgents. Besides, this engagement helps create a sense of safety among the villagers. Meaning that when the community feels connected to the military and sees them as allies rather than adversaries, it encourages civilians to stand against insurgency. The military's efforts to build this relationship promote a more cooperative spirit, where locals are more willing to share information that could prevent violence and enhance security. In essence, this approach reflects the importance of collaboration and trust in

addressing insurgency. The military's willingness to listen and engage demonstrates a shift towards a more holistic view of security—one that acknowledges that locals play an important role in their own safety and in the broader fight against extremism. This community-oriented strategy not only strengthens the military's operations but also fosters a shared commitment to peace and stability in the region. In addition to this, another participant noted another cogent approach;

We collaborate with local vigilante groups and community watch teams. We provide them with training and resources where we can since they help strengthen local security. This approach empowers these communities to take part in their own protection and create a stronger network against insurgency threats. (IDI Participant, Male, Tactical operational officer, Onitsha, aged undisclosed).

This revelation simply shows that the military have diverse ways of engagements in their operations. Apart from engagements with community members through meetings and dialogue, collaborating with local vigilante groups and community watch teams shows that it recognizes the importance of grassroots efforts in maintaining peace and security. This partnership is significant because it taps into the knowledge and trust that local groups have within their communities, making security efforts more effective. When the military provides training and resources to these local groups, it does not just enhance their abilities to respond to threats, but also fosters a sense of empowerment among community members. People feel more in control of their own safety when they have the skills and support needed to protect themselves. This empowerment is crucial, as it encourages individuals to take responsibility for their environment and discourages them from turning to violence or extremism.

Furthermore, by building a stronger network between the military and local communities, the approach helps create a united front against insurgents. Insurgents thrive on division and fear, so when communities come together with military support, it weakens their influence. This strategy highlights a shift from solely relying on military force to incorporating community participation, which is a more sustainable way of addressing the root causes of insecurity (Raimi, 2017). There is also the strategy of psychosocial operations mentioned by another interviewee. According to this participant;

The army uses media and communication to spread messages that counter the insurgents' propaganda. We try to inform the public about the dangers of joining extremist groups, promoting peace, and encouraging community resistance against the insurgents. The goal is to change the mindset of the people and show them the benefits of living in peace. (IDI Participant, Male, Tactical operational officer, Abs, aged undisclosed).

What this implies is that the army also strives on persuasion as a key tool in the fight against insurgency. Instead of just using military might, they understand the power of words and communication in shaping how people think and feel. In any case, as they engage in the use of media to spread positive messages, the army aims to counter the harmful narratives put forth by insurgents. This approach focuses on informing the public about the real dangers associated

with joining extremist groups. The army wants to make sure that people are aware of the risks, not just to themselves, but also to their families and communities. So, highlighting these dangers help to deter individuals from being drawn into a life of violence. The ideas and narratives of peace promotion encourage communities to embrace peaceful solutions and to work together against the threat of insurgency. Meaning that the fight against insurgency is about nurturing a sense of unity among the people, fostering relationships, and building a collective identity that rejects violence. When communities are united in their commitment to peace, it becomes much harder for insurgents to exert influence. Another important strategy mentioned is civic action program. According to this respondent;

The military recently started the idea of participating in programs that help improve the living conditions of the people especially in this region. One of the reasons that is said to have prompted the outbreak of insurgency here in the southeast is political marginalization and negligence, and this is why the people are said to be seeking self-determination. So, as a way of changing the narratives, we engage in these civic duties. For instance, we have resolved to contributing to building schools, healthcare clinics, and providing access to water to communities most impacted by the activities of unknown gun men. The aim is to change the narratives of political negligence and marginalization and to gain the goodwill and support from the locals, which can weaken the insurgents' influence. These insurgent groups have leveraged on these narratives to perpetuate their insecurity and carrying out their evil acts within the region for the period of their operations. (IDI Participant, Male, Tactical operational officer, Nnewi, aged undisclosed).

The observations of the military in terms of political marginalization are thoughtful. The strategy of engaging in civic duties is equally timely as it addresses some of the root causes of the unrest in the region. Importantly, the recognition that political neglect has played a role in the rise of insurgency and the steps taken to show that they care about the well-being of the people demonstrate their willingness to arrest the situation. This engagement is crucial because it seeks to mend the relationship between the military and the communities affected by violence. This is important because when people feel neglected and marginalized, they may look for alternative means of gaining power and recognition, such as turning to insurgent groups. The military's involvement in civic duties helps to change this mindset by showing a commitment to improving the lives of the people. This effort to change the narrative is significant. It provides a counterpoint to the stories being told by insurgent groups, who often exploit feelings of marginalization to gain support. Not to mention that gaining the goodwill and support of the locals is essential for long-term peace and stability. When communities feel that their concerns are being heard and that there is genuine effort to improve their living conditions, it fosters trust. This trust can create a community environment that is less susceptible to the allure of insurgency.

Theme 2: Effectiveness of these strategies in achieving peace and security in the southeast region.

While several approaches and strategies have been identified so far as measures to curb insurgency in a non-violent manner in the southeast by the military, there is also the need to examine their effectiveness in achieving peace and stability in the region. Critically, it can be said that most of the identified strategies above has been effective with some of our participants pointing out some areas where they have proven this effectiveness. For instance, one of our interviewees noted;

In many instances, when we hold meetings and engage with local leaders, it has led to important information being shared. For example, after a series of community meetings in any area attacked or facing threats of attack, local leaders felt more comfortable sharing details about suspected insurgent activities. This information allowed the military to take timely action, reducing the threat in those areas. (IDI Participant, Male, Tactical operational officer, Owerri, aged undisclosed)

The fact that local leaders feel more comfortable speaking up after these meetings reflects the importance of building relationships. It suggests that before these interactions, there may have been a hesitance or fear of speaking out against insurgents, perhaps due to concerns about safety or uncertainty about how their information would be received. However, the military's engagement helps break down these barriers. In essence, this outcome illustrates the effectiveness of a shift towards a more inclusive approach in countering insurgency. It shows that local knowledge is crucial and that communities can play a significant role in identifying and addressing threats. The military's willingness to engage with local leaders is a crucial step in creating a united front against violence, fostering hope and resilience within communities affected by insurgency. This collaborative spirit may be a key factor in not only reducing threats but also rebuilding trust and encouraging a collective commitment to peace. Another way through which these non-violent strategies has proven effective is through;

The media campaigns aimed at changing how the community viewed the insurgency have shown positive results. In one area, after a series of radio broadcasts that discussed the dangers of joining extremist factions, community feedback indicated a shift in attitudes. More people began speaking out against joining such groups, sharing personal stories of how violence had affected their families. This kind of change in mindset made it harder for insurgents to recruit young people, as the community united under the idea of promoting peace instead. (IDI Participant, Male, Tactical operational officer, ABA, aged undisclosed)

Suffice to say that strategies can only be considered effective when they address the aims or objectives intended. In this instance, the strategy of using the media to combat the influence of insurgency has led to noticeable changes in the community's attitudes. When the media launched campaigns focused on the risks of joining extremist groups, it serves as a powerful tool for shaping public perception. The fact that these messages spread through radio

broadcasts made them accessible to a wide audience, allowing many people to hear the dangers linked to such affiliations. As these messages permeated the community, it sparked conversations among residents. Many began to reflect on their experiences and share personal stories about how violence had directly affected their families. This sharing of experiences created an emotional connection and helped build a shared understanding of the violence's impact. The community started to see the reality behind joining insurgent factions, acknowledging that the consequences could deeply harm not just individuals, but entire families and the society at large. Moreover, this shift in thinking fostered a stronger sense of unity among community members. As more people spoke out against violence and recruited young people, the message of peace and stability began to gain traction. This collective mindset made it harder for insurgents to find new recruits. When the community stands together against the allure of joining these groups, the insurgents lose their power and influence. So the positive feedback from the community indicates that the media strategy was effective in reaching its goals. People began to embrace ideas of peace rather than conflict, and they realized their voice could play a significant role in creating a safer environment. This transformation in perspective not only helps diminish the insurgency's foothold but also empowers the community to take charge of its own future. Furthermore, another respondent noted that;

The little efforts we have put in training local vigilante groups has empowered them to act against insurgency in their own neighborhoods. A typical example is that, a local vigilante group that received our training was able to respond quickly to suspicious activities in their area. Their timely report to the military led to the ambush and timely arrest of several gun men and insurgents responsible for violence. This collaboration not only enhanced security but also boosted the community's confidence in their ability to protect themselves. The locals felt more engaged and less reliant on outside forces, which ultimately contributed to a more secure environment. So, you can see that that little thought out effort has proven effective in this war against insurgency in the south east. (IDI Participant, Male, Tactical operational officer, Awka, aged undisclosed).

This kind of outcomes illustrates how empowering locals can lead to significant results in the fight against insurgency. There is a ripple effect on the community's overall confidence based on these little efforts in training. So, it is clear that when locals see that they can directly contribute to their safety, it encourages them to take more initiative. They feel stronger and more capable of protecting their homes, which fosters a greater sense of unity and resilience among community members. Instead of looking outside for help, people realized that they can rely on each other and work together for their own security. Together, these small but thoughtful efforts have made a real difference in the overall fight against insurgency in the southeast. The training not only equipped local vigilantes with skills but also instilled a sense of pride and responsibility within the community. This strengthened local engagement is crucial for building a secure environment, showing that effective strategies do not always have to be grand; sometimes, they lie in empowering those right in the neighborhoods affected by conflict. Another officer also acknowledged that the initiative to contributing to building

schools and healthcare clinics has fostered a sense of hope in many communities. According to this interviewee;

In a village where the military contribute to build a new school, attendance rates among children significantly increased. Parents felt safer sending their kids to school, knowing that the military was involved in supporting education. This not only improved education in the region but also helped create a strong sense of community. Better education opportunities reduced the chances of young people being recruited by insurgent groups, as they saw a future for themselves in a peaceful society. (IDI Participant, Male, Tactical operational officer, Umuahia, aged undisclosed).

There is therefore no doubt that the compassionate involvement in civic duties has proven its efficacy and responsiveness by fostering not just individual well-being but also community growth. In a village where the military helped build a new school, we see a clear connection between the presence of support and the positive changes that followed. With the military's involvement, parents felt a stronger sense of security when sending their children to school. The reassurance that comes from knowing a respected group is looking out for the community can change people's attitudes dramatically. As attendance rates among children rose, it became evident that education was not just a priority; it was a shared value. This newfound focus on learning helped to weave a tighter community fabric, where neighbors rallied around shared interests and goals. The act of building a school transformed a physical space into a hub of hope and opportunity. Children were not merely attending classes; they were being equipped with the tools and knowledge to envision brighter futures for themselves. Also, as education improved, the appeal of insurgent groups began to wane. Young people, seeing paths forged by education and a supportive community, became less likely to consider joining such groups. They found purpose and direction within a peaceful society that valued their growth. This shift shows that compassionate civic engagement can tackle deeper issues like insurgency and other forms of violence and unrest.

Discussion of Findings

The discussion of findings is conducted in alignment with the research objectives of this study, bringing to light several key insights. The first major finding, which aligns with Objective 1 and the finding revealed that the Nigerian Army employ a multiplicity of approaches, which includes civil approach (engaging with the local communities) which helps to build trust and encourage open communication between the security units and the local population, collaborate with local vigilante groups and community watch teams, the use media campaigns and communication to spread messages that counter the insurgents' propaganda. Finding is in consonance with Chukwuma (2018), who pointed out, community perspectives are integral when evaluating military efficacy in regions facing insurgency, showing that inclusion can lead to more informed and effective security measures. This act, demonstrates the willingness in the fight against insurgency in the region by adopting approaches that focus on non-violence and community engagement. This strategy shows a recognition that true progress often comes not just from military action, but from building relationships with the people and communal group structures who are most affected by violence and instability. Engaging with local

communities reflects an understanding that the military's effectiveness is enhanced when they have the support and trust of the residents.

The second finding, which is consistent with Objective 2, indicates that the identified strategies, that is, the use of media campaigns to counter insurgent propaganda, cooperation with local vigilante groups and community watch teams, and the civil approach of interacting with local communities, have had a significant positive impact on the region's insurgency. These approaches have improved intelligence gathering and early detection of insurgent activity by increasing confidence and coordination between security forces and the local populace. By fostering community engagement and ownership of security measures, the civic approach has reduced the sense of alienation that insurgents often exploit. In a similar spirit, partnerships with neighbourhood watch teams and vigilante organisations have provided grassroots monitoring to supplement official security operations. Media and strategic communication have been critical in changing public opinion, undermining extremist ideologies, and advancing narratives of peace and unity. Overall, these initiatives have reduced insurgent influence while also improving social resilience, reducing the number of persons joining insurgent organisations, and restoring a sense of security to damaged areas. Overall, the findings demonstrate the effectiveness of integrated, community-driven, and communication-based counterinsurgency techniques in supporting regional peacebuilding and national security programs.

Conclusion and Recommendations

Based on the data obtained, presented, and discussed, the study found that the Nigerian Army plays a key role in fighting against insurgency, especially against groups like unknown gunmen who continue to wreak havoc in the region. To really tackle the problems posed by these groups, it is important to have a well-rounded approach. This needs to go beyond just military action; it also requires addressing issues like historical grievance and building strong relationships with local communities. The results show that just relying on military force will not work. Therefore, there needs to be a focus on connecting with the community, humanitarian efforts, and improving socio-economic conditions by providing jobs, building infrastructure, and providing essential services. So, if the government can gain the trust of local people, the military can be more effective in gathering information and carrying out their operations. Therefore, the study stresses the importance of using a combined strategy that includes both security and development efforts to achieve lasting peace and safety in the South East region of Nigeria. Following the findings and conclusions reached, the study offers the following recommendations:

1. As a primary strategy, the Nigerian Army should actively work on building trust with local communities through regular communication, community meetings, and involvement in local development projects. This will enhance cooperation and information sharing, leading to more effective counter-insurgency operations.
2. For the strategies to remain relevant and effective, the Nigerian military should work closely with local communities by creating regular forums or town hall meetings. These gatherings can help build trust, allowing both the military and community members to share concerns and ideas. This collaboration can include training local

volunteers for security measures, which fosters a sense of ownership and responsibility among residents.

Reference

- Adebajo, A. (2015). The Nigerian Army: Effectively Responding to Insurgency, *Conflict Trends*, 2015(1), 23-28.
- Chukwuma, E. (2018). Navigating the complexities of insurgency: Community perspectives on military interventions in southeastern Nigeria, *African Security Review*, 27(4), 310-325.
- Dawodu, O. (2020). Counter-insurgency in Nigeria: Challenges and prospects including regional cooperation, *Journal of African Security Studies*, 5(1), 30-47. <https://doi.org/10.1080/23327404.2020.1747404>
- Ekpenyong, N. S, Raimi, L. & Ekpenyong, A. S. (2012). Urban poverty and juvenile delinquency in Nigeria: Through the lens of Port Harcourt remand home inmates, *Research on Humanities and Social Sciences*, 2(8), 127-132, 2012.
- Falola, T. (2009). *The history of Nigeria*, Greenwood Press.
- Hochschild, A. (2011). *Burbank: A new history of the Nigeria civil war*, Mariner Books.
- HRW (2019). They just kill everyone”: The Rampant use of extrajudicial executions by the Nigerian Army in the Northeast. Human Rights Watch. <https://www.hrw.org/report/2019/07/24/they-just-kill-everyone/rampant-use-extrajudicial-executions-nigerian-army>
- HRW (2019). They just kill everyone”: The rampant use of extrajudicial executions by the Nigerian army in the Northeast. Human Rights Watch. <https://www.hrw.org/report/2019/07/24/they-just-kill-everyone/rampant-use-extrajudicial-executions-nigerian-army>
- Iheriohanma, E. B. J, Opara, O, & Raimi, L (2020). The Nigeria police force and its constitutional responsibility in the present democratic dispensation, *Issues Business Management and Economics*, 8(4), 84-96
- Iwarimie-Jaja, D. & Raimi, L. (2019). The criminal justice system as enablement for social order in Nigeria. *The Nigerian Journal of Sociology & Anthropology, Journal of the Nigerian Anthropological and Sociological Association (NASA)*, 17(1), 70-84.
- Iwarimie-Jaja, D. & Raimi, L. (2019). Governance, social order and development in Nigeria, *Port Harcourt Journal of Social Sciences*, (A Publication of the Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Port Harcourt), 8(1), 295-313.

- Kilcullen, D. (2013). *Out of the mountains: The coming age of the urban Guerrilla*, Hurst & Company.
- Mackinlay, J. (2007). *Globalization and insurgency*, Dando Press.
- Mawdsley, E., & Bøås, M. (2021). The insurgent and counter-insurgent: Tracing strategies, tactics, and outcomes, *Journal of Peace Research*, 58(1), 3-16. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0022343319881890>
- Okoro, A., & Ugochukwu, C. (2020). Human rights abuses by the Nigerian army: A call for accountability, *Journal of Law and Society*, 17(1), 48-65.
- Olayiwola, A. (2014). The evolution of the Nigerian army: Historical perspectives and modern implications, *The Nigerian Army Journal*, 1(1), 10-22.
- Olojo, A. (2016). Boko Haram: The challenge of reconstruction and rehabilitation, *Insight on Africa*, 8(1), 5-18. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0975087815617971>
- Oluwole, A. (2018). Democracy and military reform in Nigeria: More than just a transition? *Journal of African Security Studies*, 7(2), 145-163.
- Raimi, L. (2017). Poverty, monetization of conflict and insecurity in the Niger Delta region, *International Journal of Operational Research in Management, Social Sciences & Education*, 3(2): 42-51, September.
- Raimi, L. & Boroh, E. S. (2018). Incentivising violent behaviours in the Niger Delta region: The commodification hypothesis, *Development Studies Roundtable: A Journal of Development, UNIPORT*, 6(2), 53-61.
- Raimi, L. & Ene, R. W. (2019). Intelligence failure and insecurity in Nigeria: An analysis of the Boko Haram insurgency, *International Journal of Strategic Research in Education, Technology & Humanities*, 7(1), 106-120.
- Raimi, L. (2021). How multi-sector collaborations can reduce humanitarian crisis in North-East Nigeria, *Otuoke Journal of Social Sciences*, 1(1), 58-72.
- UN OCHA. (2021). *Nigeria: Humanitarian response plan. United Nations office for the coordination of humanitarian affairs*, Retrieved from <https://www.unocha.org/nigeria>